

令和 8 年度 福知山公立大学 地域経営学部 一般選抜 前期日程 英語予想問題 2

問題 1 次の英文の要約を 200 字以内の日本語で書きなさい。

The "2024 logistics problem" has finally become a reality in Japan. Starting in April 2024, new regulations capped the overtime hours of truck drivers to improve their working conditions. While this is a necessary step for labor rights, it has created a significant gap between the growing demand for home delivery and the actual capacity to transport goods. This crisis is felt most acutely not in large cities, but in rural regions where depopulation is already making business difficult.

For residents in remote areas, many of whom are elderly, the decline of local delivery services is a matter of survival. These individuals are often called "shopping refugees"—people who have no car and lack access to nearby stores. In the past, they relied on small-scale delivery networks or local shops. However, as transport costs rise and driver shortages worsen, many logistics companies are forced to consolidate routes or withdraw from less profitable areas altogether.

In the era of rapid e-commerce growth, the convenience of "just-in-time" delivery has been taken for granted. However, the current crisis reveals that the current model is unsustainable. For regional management, the challenge is how to maintain a lifeline when the private sector can no longer do it alone. The burden cannot be placed solely on logistics companies; a collaborative approach involving local governments and the community is essential.

Recent innovations offer some hope. Some municipalities are experimenting with "joint delivery systems," where multiple companies share a single truck to deliver goods to remote villages. Others are exploring the use of drones and autonomous vehicles for the "last mile" of delivery. Furthermore, transforming local community centers into "mini-hubs" for food and medicine can reduce the number of individual home visits required.

Ultimately, logistics should be viewed as a vital public infrastructure, similar to water or electricity. To protect rural communities, we must transition from a model of extreme convenience to one of sustainable resilience. This requires residents to accept longer delivery times and local authorities to invest in new transport networks. Without these changes, the gap between urban and rural life will only continue to widen.

【語注】 logistics : 物流 cap : ～に上限を設ける overtime hours : 時間外労働時間 home delivery : 宅配、配送料金 remote areas : 遠隔地、へき地 shopping refugees : 買い物難民 consolidate : ～を統合する、整理する e-commerce : 電子商取引(ネット通販) unsustainable : 持続不可能な joint delivery systems : 共同配送システム last mile : ラストワンマイル(配送の最終拠点から利用者までの区間) resilience : 回復力、弾力性(強靱さ)

指導講師による解答のポイント(自己採点用)

以下の要素が含まれているか確認してください。

1. **現状:** 運転手の労働規制(2024年問題)により配送能力が低下し、地方の買い物難民問題が深刻化している。

2. **課題:** 利便性を追求した従来の配送モデルは限界であり、民間単独での維持が困難になっている。
3. **解決策:** 共同配送やドローン等の技術活用、地域の拠点を活用した効率化など、産官学の連携が必要。
4. **結論:** 物流を公的なインフラと再定義し、持続可能な地域ネットワークを再構築すべき。